

DRAUGHTS · VARIANT 3 OF 20

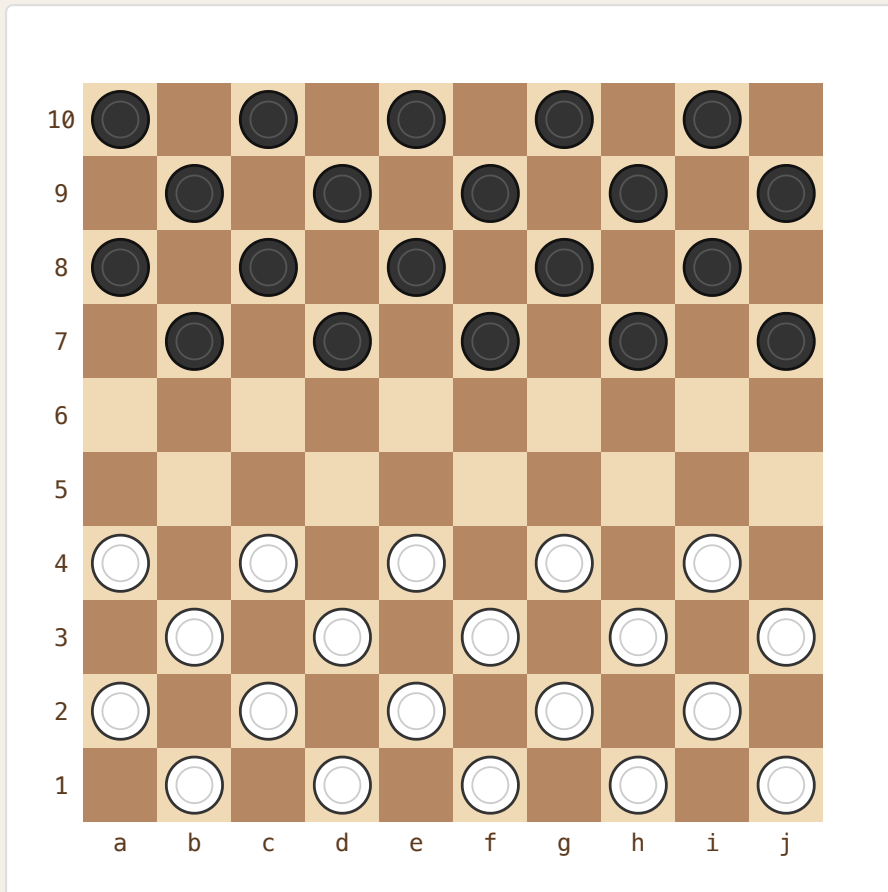
# International Draughts

**10×10**  
BOARD

**2**  
PLAYERS

# INTERNATIONAL DRAUGHTS

The competitive standard for tournament play worldwide. Evolved independently from Alquerque in the Netherlands around 1550, expanding to a 10×10 board with flying kings and strict capture priority rules. Historically called “Polish Draughts” (a misnomer from Dutch convention, not Polish origin). Governed by the World Draughts Federation (FMJD).



*International Draughts — starting position*

## SETUP

**Board:** 10×10 checkered board. Only the 50 dark squares are used. Orient the board so the long diagonal runs from each player's lower-left to upper-right.

**Pieces:** 20 men per player. Place all 20 on the dark squares of your four nearest rows. The two central rows remain empty.

**First move:** White moves first.

## RULES

- ♦ **Men movement:** Men move diagonally forward only, one square at a time, to an unoccupied dark square.
- ♦ **Men capture:** Men capture by jumping diagonally over an adjacent opponent piece to the vacant square beyond. Men can capture both forwards and backwards (unlike English Draughts).
- ♦ **Mandatory capture:** If any capture is available, it must be taken, even if disadvantageous.
- ♦ **Majority rule:** When multiple capture sequences are available, the player must choose the piece and path that captures the maximum number of pieces. If tied, the player may freely choose.
- ♦ **Delayed removal:** Captured pieces remain on the board until the entire multi-jump sequence is complete, then all are removed simultaneously. A jumped piece cannot be jumped again in the same sequence, but it still physically occupies its square during the turn.
- ♦ **No re-jumping:** A piece cannot jump over the same opponent piece twice in one sequence.

## KING PROMOTION

When a man ends its turn on the opponent's back row, it is promoted to a King (flying king).

- ♦ **Flying kings:** Kings move any number of unoccupied squares diagonally in any direction.
- ♦ **King capture:** Kings capture by jumping over a single opponent piece that is any number of empty squares away along a diagonal, landing on any open square beyond the captured piece along the same line.
- ♦ **No mid-sequence promotion:** If a man passes through the opponent's back row during a multi-jump sequence (without stopping there), it is NOT promoted. Promotion only occurs when the piece ends its turn on the back row.

## WINNING

A player wins when their opponent has no legal move available: all pieces captured or all pieces blocked.

## DRAWS

The game is a draw when:

- ♦ Both players agree.
- ♦ The same position occurs three times with the same player to move.
- ♦ 25 consecutive king moves pass with no capture and no man movement.
- ♦ Neither player can force a win.

## STRATEGY

The 10x10 board rewards long-range planning. Flying kings dominate the endgame, so preventing your opponent's promotion while securing your own is critical. The majority capture rule creates combination opportunities: sacrifice pieces to force your opponent into a capture sequence that leaves them exposed.

## ATTRIBUTION

Traditional variant. Public domain. Rules standardised by the World Draughts Federation (FMJD). Source: FMJD Official Rules, Wikipedia (CC-BY-SA).